Guitar Exercises - Section XV, Level 104

Complete Original-Work Production

Compose • Arrange • Revise • Rehearse • Record • Critique • Finalize

Level 104 of 105. This completes Section XV. HARD STOP after Level 105.

The objective is to finish music. Define the work, compose it, arrange it, remove weak material, rehearse the performance, record complete takes, critique evidence, revise once more, and declare a final version.

Module	Exercise	Events
A	Creative brief and identity lock	96
B	Primary-piece composition draft	160
C	Arrangement and orchestration pass	144
D	Structural revision and subtraction	128
E	Performance-specific guitar revision	128
F	Rehearsal planning and risk closure	112
G	Recording passes and take discipline	128
H	Critique, comparison, and final revision	128
I	Primary + contrasting companion-piece capstone	352
J	Section XV completion audit	64
	TOTAL	1440

Core rule: finished and defensible outranks endlessly improvable.

Production Gate Sequence

Gate	Question
Brief	What is this piece trying to be?
Identity	What must survive every revision?
Draft	Does a complete form exist?
Arrangement	Does every part have a responsibility?
Revision	What should be removed or rewritten?
Rehearsal	Can it survive performance?
Recording	Can a complete take be captured?
Critique	What does recording reveal?
Final	What version is authoritative?

Complete the page before advancing. Preserve the three locked identity elements unless evidence shows the piece itself has failed.

Module A - Creative Brief

Field	Write before composing
Working title	
One-sentence identity	
Primary groove	
Tonal center(s)	
Core motif/hook	
Primary guitar role	
Maximum technical difficulty	
Target duration/form	
One thing explicitly excluded	

Complete the page before advancing. Preserve the three locked identity elements unless evidence shows the piece itself has failed.

Module A - Identity Lock

Element	Non-negotiable?	Why?
Motif/hook		
Groove		
Bass behavior		
Chord movement		
Register/texture		
Dynamic arc		
Ending		

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Module B - Primary Piece Draft

Stage	Deliverable
1	form skeleton + bar counts
2	harmonic-function map
3	bass map
4	motif/melody map
5	groove map
6	section transitions
7	ending
8	one uninterrupted rough performance

Complete the page before advancing. Preserve the three locked identity elements unless evidence shows the piece itself has failed.

Module B - Draft Constraints

Constraint	Requirement
Length	32-64 bars
Sections	minimum 3 distinct jobs
Identity	one recurring motif/hook
Contrast	one section differs in 2+ variables
Return	one recognizable thematic return
Harmony	clear departure and arrival
Dynamics	one planned peak
Ending	written, not accidental

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Module C - Arrangement Responsibility

Layer	Owner	Remove if redundant?
Foundation/root		
Harmony/guide tones		
Groove		
Hook		
Counterline		
Lead/solo		
Texture		
Transition cues		

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Module C - Arrangement Versions

Version	Requirement
Solo/reduced	piece survives with one guitar
Core ensemble	foundation + harmony/groove + lead identity
Expanded	optional second guitar/texture/counterline
50% reduction	half secondary material removed
Emergency	roots/shells + hook + landmarks

Complete the page before advancing. Preserve the three locked identity elements unless evidence shows the piece itself has failed.

Module D - Structural Revision

Question	Revision
Weakest section?	rewrite or shorten
Redundant section?	remove
Too many peaks?	choose one primary peak
Return too literal?	vary one structural variable
Return unrecognizable?	restore motif/rhythm
Bridge unrelated?	restore identity feature
Transition over-written?	reduce to destination
Ending weak?	rewrite final 2-4 bars

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Module D - Reduction Test

Version	Keep
100%	complete piece
75%	remove secondary fills/extensions
50%	form + groove + hook + harmonic landmarks
Identity-only	motif + bass/function + ending

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Module E - Guitar-Specific Revision

Problem	Revision
Awkward voicing	inversion/shell
Unsung lead phrase	simplify contour/rhythm
Unreliable bend	slide/plain target
Riff only works too fast	rewrite density
Bass/melody collision	separate register
Gain-dependent sustain	rewrite sustain function
Impossible transition jump	end previous phrase earlier
Solo overpowers piece	shorten/target motif

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Module E - Performance Economy

Pass	Restriction
1	no ornament
2	one articulation family/section
3	no fill longer than half bar
4	maximum one technical climax
5	50% fewer solo notes
6	perform at 90% target tempo
7	perform at target tempo

Complete the page before advancing. Preserve the three locked identity elements unless evidence shows the piece itself has failed.

Module F - Rehearsal Risk Register

Risk	0-4	Fallback
Form memory		
Highest-risk transition		
Groove stability		
Hardest voicing/shift		
Lead/solo reliability		
Dynamic peak		
Ending		

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Module F - Rehearsal Ladder

Pass	Task
1	roots/form only
2	rhythm arrangement
3	hook/landmarks
4	complete arrangement
5	memory take
6	recovery take with injected error
7	two consecutive complete takes

Complete the page before advancing. Preserve the three locked identity elements unless evidence shows the piece itself has failed.

Module G - Recording Pass Discipline

Take	Purpose
1	documentation - no stopping
2	performance - best current interpretation
3	reduced - 50% secondary material
4	alternate - one changed arrangement decision
5	final candidate - after critique

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Module G - Recording Evidence Log

Section	Observed issue	Class	Action

Complete the page before advancing. Preserve the three locked identity elements unless evidence shows the piece itself has failed.

Module H - Critique Hierarchy

Priority	Question
1. Form	Does the piece make structural sense?
2. Identity	Can hook/motif be remembered?
3. Groove	Does time feel intentional?
4. Harmony	Do departure/arrival work?
5. Arrangement	Are roles clear?
6. Expression	Does intensity have shape?
7. Technique	Are errors distracting?
8. Tone	Does sound support arrangement?

Complete the page before advancing. Preserve the three locked identity elements unless evidence shows the piece itself has failed.

Module H - A/B Revision Comparison

Compare	Choose
Original vs shortened form	stronger direction
Full vs reduced arrangement	clearer identity
Original vs simplified solo	serves piece better
Two endings	more inevitable
Two tempos	breathes better
Two voicing plans	clearer register roles

Complete the page before advancing. Preserve the three locked identity elements unless evidence shows the piece itself has failed.

Module I - Primary Work Capstone

Deliverable	Requirement
Length	32-64 bars
Form	3+ section jobs
Identity	recurring motif/hook
Harmony	direction/departure/return
Arrangement	solo/reduced + core
Dynamics	planned arc and peak
Performance	two consecutive complete rehearsals
Recording	final candidate take
Documentation	one-page map
Revision log	3+ evidence-based changes

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Module I - Contrasting Companion Piece

Dimension	Must contrast primary in at least four
Groove	different engine
Tonal center	major/minor/modal contrast
Tempo	slower/faster
Form	different architecture
Register	different primary range
Density	sparser/denser
Starting method	motif/melody/bass/rhythm first
Expression	different articulation/dynamic language

Complete the page before advancing. Preserve the three locked identity elements unless evidence shows the piece itself has failed.

Module I - Final Section XV Portfolio

Item	Required
Primary piece	final recording + map
Companion piece	final recording + map
Primary reduced version	complete take
Primary alternate arrangement	complete take
Composition brief	both pieces
Revision notes	both pieces
Performance fallback	both pieces
One-sentence identity	both pieces

Complete the page before advancing. Preserve the three locked identity elements unless evidence shows the piece itself has failed.

Module J - Section XV Completion Audit

Category	0	1	2
Identity	unclear	functional	memorable
Form	weak	complete	architected
Harmony/groove	directionless	functional	purposeful
Arrangement	cluttered	usable	role-driven
Revision	cosmetic	some improvement	evidence-based
Performance	fragile	complete	confident
Recording critique	vague	useful	diagnostic
Finalization	never closes	declared	defensible

Pass Section XV: 14/16 or better, with no zero in identity, form, performance, or finalization.

Section XV is complete. Level 105 is the FINAL MUSICIANSHIP CAPSTONE: technique, fretboard, harmony, rhythm, ear, improvisation, repertoire, arrangement, composition, recovery, and complete performance.

HARD STOP: no Level 106 in the universal curriculum.